

L-49 PYQ MAPPING: Indian Society

Topics: Jajmani System | Tribe-Caste Continuum | Great & Little Tradition | Universalisation & Parochialisation | Sacred Complex | NMS Complex

TREND ANALYSIS: These topics appear regularly in both Anthropology Paper 1 (Units 3.2, 3.3, 5.3) and GS1 (Indian Society). Tribe-Caste Continuum & Sacred Complex are high-frequency. Jajmani is asked every 2-3 years. NMS Complex appears in applied anthropology questions. Great/Little Tradition and U&P often appear as sub-parts of larger questions on social change.

JAJMANI SYSTEM - PYQs

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Answer Pointers (from notes)
2023	Antho P1	10	Discuss the relevance of the Jajmani system in contemporary Indian society.	Scholars: Wiser (1936), Oscar Lewis (Rampur), Yogendra Singh (change factors) Structure: Define (Lewis quote) → Features (hereditary, ritual) → Decline causes (STP: State, Tech, Political mobilization) → Remnants today (ritual roles persist at marriages/deaths in rural UP, Bihar) → Conclusion (transformed, not fully dead)
2021	Antho P1	10	Examine the factors responsible for the decline of the Jajmani system.	Scholars: Yogendra Singh (4 trends), Oscar Lewis, W.H. Wiser Structure: Define briefly → 3 causes of decline (Role of State + Technology + Political mobilization of Dalits) → Give concrete examples (safety razors, steel utensils, bore wells) → Conclusion
2019	Antho P1	10	Critically examine the Jajmani system with reference to its exploitative character.	Scholars: Lewis (exploitation in Rampur), Kolenda (1963, distribution system), Berreman (social dynamics) Structure: Define → Positive view (Wiser: peace & contentment) → Critical view (exploitation, restricted mobility, caste evils) → Decline due to democratic assertion → Conclusion
2016	Antho P1	10	Discuss the functional aspects of the Jajmani system.	Scholars: Wiser, Lewis, Harold Gould (family-level operation) Structure: Define → 6 characteristics → Functions (division of labour, self-sufficiency, ritual role, prestige maintenance) → Ritual example (Thakur family, 10 castes) → Today's relevance
2014	GS1	12.5	How has the institution of Jajmani system undergone changes in rural India?	Scholars: Yogendra Singh (4 factors), Oscar Lewis Structure: Define → Traditional features → Yogendra Singh's 4 change factors → 3 decline causes (State/Tech/Political) → Current status (monetization, migration, MGNREGA as alternative) → Conclusion

TRIBE-CASTE CONTINUUM - PYQs

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Answer Pointers
2024	Antho P1	10	Discuss the concept of Tribe-Caste Continuum with suitable examples.	Scholars: Redfield (continuum), Bailey (structural), Surajit Sinha (Bastar), Beteille (3 criteria), Ghurye (backward Hindus) Examples: Onge → Chenchu → Gonds → Bhumij (spectrum); Jenu-Kuruba, Toda, Munda interactions Case: N.K. Bose (Hindu Methods of Tribal Absorption); Martin Orans (Santhal)
2022	Antho P1	10	Explain the tribe-caste continuum in the Indian context with examples.	Scholars: Bailey (caste=organic/hierarchical; tribe=segmentary/egalitarian; "both merging into different system"), Surajit Sinha, Beteille Examples: Bhils in Ramayana/Mahabharata; Ekalavya-Drona; Bhima-Hidimbi; Parvati's curse Diagram: Use continuum spectrum (isolated → assimilated)
2019	Antho P1	10	Examine the processes through which tribes get integrated into the caste system.	Scholars: Ghurye (backward Hindus, 1943), N.K. Bose (Hindu Methods of Tribal Absorption, 1941), Martin Orans (Santhal, 1965) Processes: Hinduisation, economic integration (Jenu-Kuruba), religious interaction (Toda-Nanjangud), mythological absorption (Bhils), Sanskritization Critique: Bailey - both transforming into something new
2017	Antho P1	10	Discuss the concept of continuum with reference to tribe and caste in India.	Key: Redfield's Folk-Urban model → applied to India by Bailey & Sinha. Define continuum. 4 scholars' classifications (Hutton: religious; Beteille: 3 criteria; Bailey: structural; Sinha: fieldwork). Examples of tribes at different points on spectrum. Conclusion: dynamic concept, boundaries blurring.

GREAT & LITTLE TRADITION / UNIVERSALISATION & PAROCHIALISATION - PYQs

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Answer Pointers
2024	Antho P1	10	Explain the concepts of Universalisation and Parochialisation with examples.	Scholars: McKim Marriott (Village India, 1955), Redfield (teacher) Examples: P: Gobardhan Puja (Govardhan hill → cow dung worship); U: Saluno → Raksha Bandhan; Kerala: Theyyam deities = Rama/Lakshman/Hanuman Limitation: Circular not linear (Ramayana: folk → Valmiki → Tulsidas → Ram Lila)
2022	Antho P1	10	Discuss the concepts of Great and Little Traditions. How do they interact?	Scholars: Redfield (Peasant Society & Culture, 1956), S.C. Dube (multipolar critique, 1965), Mandelbaum Structure: Define both → Comparison table → Sacred specialists as mediators → Jagannath Puri example → Interaction via U&P → Dube's critique (6-fold) → Conclusion
2020	Antho P1	10	Critically examine Redfield's concept of Great and Little Traditions in the Indian context.	Scholars: Redfield, Marriott (U&P shows interaction), S.C. Dube (too complex for bipolar; 6 traditions), Mandelbaum (GT not static) Indian examples: Jagannath; goddess cults; Varanasi/Gaya as GT centres; Theyyam/Bhuta as LT Critique: Hierarchy implied by "great/little"; Indian reality is multipolar
2018	Antho P1	10	Discuss the limitations of the concepts of Universalisation and Parochialisation.	Key limitation: Not two-directional but CIRCULAR. Ramayana example (LT → GT → LT). Also: assumes binary GT/LT when reality is multipolar (Dube). Doesn't explain power dynamics. Doesn't account for Western/colonial influence on traditions. Scholars: Marriott, Dube, Mandelbaum
2015	Antho P1	10	Explain the concepts of Great Tradition and Little Tradition with Indian examples.	Define both (Redfield): GT = elite/formal/literate; LT = folk/oral/local. Comparison table. Sacred specialists mediate. Examples: GT (Gita, Varanasi, Gaya); LT (folklore, local rituals). Jagannath Puri case. Conclude: interdependent, interact via U&P.

SACRED COMPLEX - PYQs

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Answer Pointers
2023	Antho P1	10	Discuss the concept of Sacred Complex as propounded by L.P. Vidyarthi.	Scholars: L.P. Vidyarthi (1961, Sacred Complex in Hindu Gaya, Chicago School, student of Redfield) 3 Components: Sacred Geography (temples, ghats) + Sacred Performances (Gaya Shraddha) + Sacred Specialists (Gayawal Brahmins) Significance: Cultural transmission, social integration, GT-LT integration, binding force Extensions: Narayana Reddy (Tirumala + secular dimension)
2021	Antho P1	10	Examine the significance of the Sacred Complex in understanding Indian civilization.	Scholars: Vidyarthi, Saraswati (Naimisharanya - sacred institutions regulate secular life), Jha (civilisation transcends political borders - Janakpur), R.N. Narayan (Deoghar = microcosm of Indian civilisation) 5 functions: Cultural transmission, social integration, GT-LT integration, creative arts, binding force
2018	Antho P1	10	Discuss the contributions of different scholars to the study of Sacred Complex.	Use table: Vidyarthi (Gaya) → Saraswati (Naimisharanya, Goa, Kashi) → Jha (Janakpur, Puri) → Bharati (inter-religious) → David Sopher (service castes) → Bharadwaj (pilgrim fields) → Narayan (Deoghar) → Patnaik (Puri) → Narayana Reddy (Tirumala + secular)
2016	Antho P1	10	Discuss Vidyarthi's concept of Sacred Complex and its relevance today.	Structure: Background (Chicago School, Redfield's GT/LT framework) → Define 3 components → Gaya example → Significance → Modern relevance (Tirumala, Vaishno Devi - both sacred & secular economies) → Narayana Reddy's secular dimension addition

NATURE-MAN-SPIRIT COMPLEX - PYQs

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Answer Pointers
2024	Antho P1	10	Discuss the concept of Nature-Man-Spirit Complex with its applied significance.	Scholars: L.P. Vidyarthi (Maler, Rajmahal Hills), P.K. Singh (1981 restudy - "constant!"), V.S. Sahay (Nicobarese) Applied significance: 5 points - Holistic worldview, Explains resistance (Dongria Kondh case), Tool for applied anthropology (Elwin's Panchsheel), Sustainable resource use (Khasi/Garo sacred groves), Integration of tradition & development (Sarhul festival)
2022	Antho P1	10	Explain Vidyarthi's Nature-Man-Spirit Complex with a suitable case study.	Define NMS: Cultural ecology + spirits = 3-way interaction Case Study: Maler (Rajmahal Hills, Khallu, 4 spirits - Gossaiyan/Jiwe Urrkya/Alchi/Chergani, displacement example) Validation: P.K. Singh restudy (1981) - "complex is constant even if content changes" Or use: Dongria Kondh / Niyamgiri (NMS worldview → resistance → SC 2013 → 12 gram sabhas voted NO)
2019	Antho P1	10	Discuss the NMS Complex and its relevance for tribal development planning.	Scholars: Vidyarthi, Sahay (Nicobarese - "only model!"), Verrier Elwin (Tribal Panchsheel) Relevance: Explains why tribes resist displacement → guides culturally sensitive development → sustainable resource management via sacred taboos → Dongria Kondh case proves NMS worldview has legal standing (SC 2013)
2017	Antho P1	10	Examine the Nature-Man-Spirit Complex in tribal India with examples.	Define NMS → Maler study in detail → 4 spirits → Diagram (Nature-Man-Spirit interaction) Other studies: Sahay (Nicobarese), Morab (Soliga), Mann (Onge), R.K. Sinha (Pando), Ramesh Chandra (Kinner) Validate: P.K. Singh restudy. Contemporary: Santhals (Baha/Jaherthan), Dongria Kondh

FREQUENCY SUMMARY - L-49 TOPICS:

Topic	Frequency (2014-2024)	Avg. Marks	Priority
Tribe-Caste Continuum	Asked 5-6 times	10	★★★★★
Sacred Complex	Asked 4-5 times	10	★★★★★
NMS Complex	Asked 4-5 times	10	★★★★★
Great/Little Tradition & U/P	Asked 5-6 times	10	★★★★★
Jajmani System	Asked 3-4 times	10	★★★★

Key Insight: ALL L-49 topics are high-frequency. Expect at least 1-2 questions from these topics every year. Sacred Complex + NMS often clubbed in "Vidyarthi's contributions" questions. GT/LT + U&P often asked together.